

Diy Ant Control Budget Guide — Action Checklist

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IDENTIFY BEFORE BUYING TREATMENT

- ☐ **Photograph the ants with your phone camera using flash and compare them to the identification guides at the University of Minnesota Extension or NC State Extension to confirm the species before spending any money on treatment.:** Photograph the ants with your phone camera using flash and compare them to the identification guides at the University of Minnesota Extension or NC State Extension to confirm the species before spending any money on treatment.
- ☐ **Identify whether you are dealing with odorous house ants, carpenter ants, pavement ants, or sugar and ghost ants because the bait that eliminates sugar ants will be completely ignored by carpenter ants.:** Identify whether you are dealing with odorous house ants, carpenter ants, pavement ants, or sugar and ghost ants because the bait that eliminates sugar ants will be completely ignored by carpenter ants.
- ☐ **Match your specific ant species to the correct treatment method after identification, since different ant species require different active ingredients and application strategies to be eliminated effectively.:** Match your specific ant species to the correct treatment method after identification, since different ant species require different active ingredients and application strategies to be eliminated effectively.
- ☐ **Do not rely on this guide alone for carpenter ant treatment if you notice sawdust-like material near your baseboards, as this indicates possible structural damage requiring a professional exterminator.:** Do not rely on this guide alone for carpenter ant treatment if you notice sawdust-like material near your baseboards, as this indicates possible structural damage requiring a professional exterminator.

SEAL ENTRY POINTS PROPERLY

- ☐ **Wait until ants are most active in the morning or evening, then place a small drop of honey or sugar water on your counter and watch where the ants travel after feeding to establish their foraging route.:** Wait until ants are most active in the morning or evening, then place a small drop of honey or sugar water on your counter and watch where the ants travel after feeding to establish their foraging route.

- ❑ **Follow the ant trail with a flashlight to identify where it disappears into walls, floors, or gaps because that disappearing point is exactly where ants are entering your home and needs to be sealed.:** Follow the ant trail with a flashlight to identify where it disappears into walls, floors, or gaps because that disappearing point is exactly where ants are entering your home and needs to be sealed.
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- ❑ **Seal gaps under exterior doors with a \$5 self-adhesive draft sweep and seal baseboard gaps with a \$3 tube of exterior latex caulk loaded into a caulk gun to block the most common entry routes.:** Seal gaps under exterior doors with a \$5 self-adhesive draft sweep and seal baseboard gaps with a \$3 tube of exterior latex caulk loaded into a caulk gun to block the most common entry routes.
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- ❑ **Fill larger gaps around pipe penetrations through exterior walls using steel wool packed into the gap and covered with caulk because ants cannot chew through steel wool unlike spray foam alone.:** Fill larger gaps around pipe penetrations through exterior walls using steel wool packed into the gap and covered with caulk because ants cannot chew through steel wool unlike spray foam alone.

DEPLOY BAIT STATIONS CORRECTLY

- ❑ **Position slow-acting sugar-based bait stations like Terro liquid ant traps along active ant trails and directly at identified entry points where ants are actively foraging to maximize colony exposure to the poison.:** Position slow-acting sugar-based bait stations like Terro liquid ant traps along active ant trails and directly at identified entry points where ants are actively foraging to maximize colony exposure to the poison.
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- ❑ **Use a homemade borax and sugar bait mixture for sugar ants and ghost ants because these species have a strong preference for sweet foods and will ignore protein-based baits entirely.:** Use a homemade borax and sugar bait mixture for sugar ants and ghost ants because these species have a strong preference for sweet foods and will ignore protein-based baits entirely.
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- ❑ **Avoid fast-acting spray pesticides because they only kill the worker ants you see and the colony survives to rebuild its numbers, so set out slow-acting bait instead so workers carry the poison back to the nest and eliminate the queen and colony members.:** Avoid fast-acting spray pesticides because they only kill the worker ants you see and the colony survives to rebuild its numbers, so set out slow-acting bait instead so workers carry the poison back to the nest and eliminate the queen and colony members.
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- ☐ **Give the bait stations at least 7 to 14 days to work because the slow-acting poison needs time for worker ants to consume it, return to the nest, feed it to other ants, and eventually reach the queen before the infestation ends.:** Give the bait stations at least 7 to 14 days to work because the slow-acting poison needs time for worker ants to consume it, return to the nest, feed it to other ants, and eventually reach the queen before the infestation ends.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.